

Assignment Three: Socioemotional and Cognitive Analysis Report

1. Overview

Word count: 1500 words

Assessment requirement: Apply socioemotional and cognitive theories of human development to your chosen case study.

Learning Outcomes Assessed: 1, 2, 3, 4, and 5



2. Instructions

Assignment three requires the application of socioemotional and cognitive theories of human development to your chosen case study story. You must use the same case story that you used in assignment two. Ensure your application of theory is well-developed and include clear examples that are well connected to theory and focused on the main character in your case story.

For the purposes of this assignment, we are using 'theory' as an umbrella term that encompasses concepts and theories that help us understand human development.

Application of Socioemotional Theory

For this part of the analysis, you are required to introduce and apply Erikson's psychosocial theory, and at least one other theory that addresses aspects of psychosocial development relevant to the ages and stages of the main character in your case story. The second socioemotional theory options are listed below. Select a theory or theories that are a good fit for your case story character's age and context.

For each theory, give a brief introduction to the principles of the theory itself, followed by a description of the stages or concepts that apply to the main character. Cite course literature in your explanations and include page numbers. Follow this with at least one well developed example from the case study. Be thorough in your introduction, definitions, and application of theory in this section.

Socioemotional theory two options:

- Activity theory
- Attachment theory (Bowlby and Ainsworth)
- Autonomy (self-determination theory)
- Friendships or peer relationships (Sullivan)
- Identity (Marcia)
- Life events approach
- Life review (Butler)
- Love (Sternberg)
- Moral development (Kohlberg)
- Parenting styles (focus on character)
- Seasons of life (Levinson)
- Selective optimisation with compensation theory
- Self-efficacy (Bandura)
- Self-understanding and understanding of others (Harter)
- Socioemotional selectivity
- Successful ageing



Application of Cognitive Theory

For this section of the analysis, select a cognitive theory from the list below which best applies to the developmental age/stage of the main character in your case study. Again, introduce the principles of your selected theory, describe key features of the cognitive stage, or key concepts, relevant to your main character, and give well developed examples from the story to illustrate. Cite course literature in your explanations and include page numbers.

If you are using an adult case story (middle adulthood, middle adulthood or late adulthood), you also need to address postformal thought in this section. This could involve acknowledging post-formal thought as an extension of Piaget's theory and describing the key concepts/ideas of post-formal thought. You would then move on to identify and describe a cognitive theory, and apply that to your case study.

Cognitive theory options:

- Achievement, motivation, goal setting and grit
- Expertise
- Fluid and crystallised intelligence
- Information Processing
- Piaget
- Schaie
- Vygotsky
- Wisdom

Evaluation

Finish your analysis with a brief critique of the usefulness (or otherwise) of developmental theory to help one understand the main features of this particular case study. Marks will be awarded on the basis of your ability to demonstrate the limitations of a chosen developmental theory - it might be helpful to select just one theory to discuss. Give your own reasoned opinion here, not just a summary of the theories that were applied. This is a piece of reflective writing and should indicate the way your understanding of human development has grown. Citations are not required in this section.

References

Remember to include your reference list using APA 7. It is our expectation that students make good use of the course textbook and readings in this assignment. Tell us which page numbers from the course text/readings you have referred to in your citations.



4. Case Study Stories

A Friendly Reminder

You must continue using the same case study in this assessment as you did in Assessment 2.

The case study stories are as follows:

- Middle Childhood
- Adolescence
- Early Adulthood
- Middle Adulthood
- Late Adulthood



4. Case Study Stories

4.2. Adolescence

Cyberbullying

This case study story focuses on the story of an adolescent who has experienced cyberbullying.

Carrie waited uncomfortably outside Ms Calcott's office. Her palms were sweating, and she was desperately hoping that no one would see her here waiting to see the School Guidance Counsellor. Part of her just felt like taking off right now, but after thinking through all the alternatives and possibilities as much as she could, this was the only way she could think of to deal with the situation. As she had done so many times over the last month, she wondered how it had come to this and why. She really hoped Ms Calcott could help her find some answers to that, as well as ideas on how to handle the bullying. Because that is what it was, Carrie knew. Weird that no one had ever actually said anything to her face and certainly no one had ever physically bullied her – the sorts of things Mum and Dad might think of as bullying – but she had seen a documentary on cyberbullying and how it was an increasing problem and she knew that the government had enacted the Harmful Digital Communications Bill, setting up ways to complain. If it was happening to her, it was happening to other people, and she wanted to stop it for herself and make a difference for other kids.

She was 13 and in Year 9 at Girl's High. Her Dad had worked for several oil companies and the family had moved quite a lot during Carrie's life, as he moved on to new roles. They had had a year living in London when she and Giles, her older brother, were at primary school, and then a year in Brussels, where she and Giles had gone to an international school, which she loved. So much fun learning different languages from the other girls; she still had close friends from that time and kept in touch through Facebook. They came back to New Zealand and lived in Christchurch for a couple of years. She had made friends in school there and had hoped to go to High School with them, but it wasn't to be, and they moved again at the end of last year when Dad had been promoted again and had relocated to Head Office.

She and Giles had been close when they were overseas, good friends in a different country. But Giles was now 15 and different; he didn't really want to know his little sister. They really didn't have much to do with each other, especially as they went to different schools and travelled separately. The time when they might have been together, like walking home, just wasn't there and Carrie didn't feel she could reach out to him for help. For all she knew, Giles was unhappy adjusting to the changes in their lives too, but he didn't show it.

When they moved here, Mum had bought a small florist's business in the suburb where they were living. She had not worked at all in the years that Carrie and Giles had been at primary school, but she had always been interested and involved in floristry and floral groups. Carrie knew that Mum had told Dad that it was her turn to do something for herself and it was now his turn to support her in her new business. Mum was working long hours getting the business going – usually, she was gone and at the markets when they got up for school and she and Giles had to be much more independent. It just added to all the strangeness of things and again, it just wasn't like the old days when she could come home and talk to Mum. Now she came home to an empty house and didn't want to bother Mum when she looked so tired at night.



Girl's High was the first all-girls school Carrie had been to. She had always gone to nice schools and had all girls for friends, but there was something different about a school with just girls. It seemed to be really hard to fit into the groups, especially where girls had all known each other for quite a while. Even though she had been here a while, it was still a bit hard to pick what the rules were for belonging to the groups and Carrie had had some trouble fitting in. She had made a contact even before she started here and had thought it would be easy because of that. Jane was one of the really popular girls in Year 9 and her father worked for Carrie's Dad in the company Head Office. Mum and Dad had had Jane's family over for a barbeque in the summer and Carrie thought Jane had been nice and friendly. Now she wasn't so sure, and she actually thought Jane might be behind some of the trouble. But because of the link to Dad's work, she didn't think she could say anything to Mum and Dad.

She had her own Instagram account, of course – everyone did. Even though you weren't supposed to have an Instagram account until you were 13, she, like lots of other kids, had had one for ages. It was a great way to keep up with her old friends and of course she had sent Jane a follow request after they met. It was a bit odd that it had taken quite a while for Jane to accept her request – Carrie thought you should accept anyone who asked, because it was just being polite and friendly. It was a way of making new friends too, and Carrie had been hurt when some of the girls at Girls' High had not responded to her follow requests. She was beginning to understand that it was all a part of the rules of who could belong. Carrie was lucky that Dad brought back iPhones for her and Giles on his last trip overseas. So now she could access Instagram and TikTok anytime and it seemed to be always there, with people gossiping and often putting other people down. Jane had made comments about iPhones and 'rich bitches' that she thought were aimed at her. She had seen a comment from Jane too about 'real friends' and 'friends I'm forced to have'.

She found out, when they first met, that Jane was on the swim team for their school, so one of the first things she did was to sign up too. She was a good swimmer and had always got involved in competitions at her old school. Her body was changing though, and she was a bit more self-conscious than she had been. Over the summer, she had got a lot taller, and she was nowhere near as flat chested as she had been. The swimming team used the local pool for training, as did Boys' High, and the boys looked them up and down in ways she had never been conscious of just a year or so earlier. One of her big worries was about shaving her legs. Her Mum was adamant that she shouldn't be shaving her legs yet and that it would only grow back thicker! Her hair was very blond, but Carrie was increasingly self-conscious about it and felt as though everyone was looking at her legs. She had talked to one of the other girls on the team about it and that was probably a mistake because in no time others had made teasing comments about hairy legs – just in fun, but it seemed as though there was more to it.

She had seen silly stuff on the other girls' Instagram accounts about hairy legs too – not directly about her, but there was a lot of laughing about it and she started to have the uncomfortable feeling that there was something going on she didn't know about. Then yesterday, Andrea, one of the older girls on the team, and a really good swimmer who didn't need to belong to the cool girls' group, had come to find her to show her an Instagram the other girls were talking about at training. She had followed it up, and she had been horrified to find it was a Whose Legs page and the legs were clearly the girls on their team. There were no faces, but you could tell who it was, or you could if you knew the girls. You could vote for the legs and one of the categories was Hairiest Legs. The photo of her legs had been taken in such a way to really highlight the hair on her legs and it had by far and away the most votes and the comments were awful. Andrea had also told her that she had seen Snapchat photos of Carrie getting changed after training, some quite explicit and all really unflattering. Carrie felt so mortified and humiliated.

She had had a sleepless night about it and felt very stressed today thinking about how everyone was laughing at her. But she had decided this wasn't right and it wasn't just her who was the target here. She told Ms Calcott about it and showed her the website and told her about the Snapchat photos and captions, though of course they had disappeared. Ms Calcott said there was a school 'zero tolerance' bullying policy, and she said she would do whatever she could. However, she also said that the school had only recently begun working on a policy to cover cyberbullying and that she wasn't really sure where to start in tracking down the anonymous person/people who had put up the page. She also wasn't sure how they stood since no faces were used. But she thought that Andrea might be able to help about the Snapchat photos. She said she would talk to the principal and that they might ask NetSafe about how to get the page removed, telling her that she had recently received useful resources from NetSafe on ways to manage cyberbullying. Carrie thought she was taking it really seriously and felt reassured.



Ms Calcott then talked to her about why she hadn't discussed it with her Mum and Dad about it and it all came out – the move, Mum working, Dad's work and how she didn't want to cause trouble there. When Ms Calcott said she would like to ask Mum and Dad to come in to help them all talk about it together, she had agreed, with relief.

3. Report Format

We propose a report format that aligns with the headings below. Word counts are suggestions and you are welcome to use more or less in any section provided your submission is +- 10% of 1500 words.

(a) Socioemotional Theory

Erikson

450 words

Second socioemotional theory

450 words

(b) Cognitive Theory

450 words

(c) Evaluation

150 words

(d) References

Remember to ensure each section covers all points required in the instructions. For the theory sections, this includes introducing the theory and it's key principles, identifying the relevant stage/concept for your case story character and applying the relevant stage/concept to your case story character's development.

You do not need to include a report introduction or conclusion.

